

Personal Memo

To: Myself

From: Myself

Date: January 13, 2026

Subject: Remember This

Things I Need to Remember

1. **Write tests first.** TDD isn't just a methodology - it's a way of life.
2. **Keep functions small.** If a function does more than one thing, it's doing too much.
3. **Name things clearly.** `calculateTotal` is better than `calc`. `getUserById` is better than `getUser`.
4. **Document why, not what.** The code shows what. Comments should explain why.
5. **Refactor fearlessly.** Technical debt compounds. Pay it down regularly.
6. **Ask for help.** There's no shame in not knowing. There's shame in not asking.
7. **Take breaks.** Your brain needs rest. Your code will be better if you're rested.

8. **Celebrate small wins.** Fixed a bug? Celebrate. Wrote a test? Celebrate. Made code cleaner? Celebrate.

9. **Learn continuously.** Technology changes. Stay curious. Stay learning.

10. **Be kind to future you.** Write code that future you will thank you for.

Things I Should Stop Doing

- Writing functions longer than 20 lines
 - Skipping tests "just this once"
 - Using magic numbers instead of constants
 - Writing comments that say "TODO: Fix this later"
 - Assuming I'll remember why I did something
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Things I Should Start Doing

- Writing more tests
- Refactoring more often
- Asking for code reviews earlier
- Documenting decisions, not just code

- Taking more breaks
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Final Thought

Code is communication. Write code that communicates clearly, and you'll write better code.

End of memo